SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #75 · RESURRECTION & THE BODY

“I won’t know my loved ones after the resurrection.”

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Where it often comes from

Grief over someone you deeply miss. Hearing that in heaven we will be so focused on God that we won’t know anyone. Jesus’ words that there is no marriage in the resurrection, which can feel like a loss of relationship. Vague ideas about heaven. Fear that your love will be lost.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture gives us strong reasons for hope. Paul comforted grieving believers that God will bring with Jesus those who have died, and that we will be together with them and with the Lord. Moses and Elijah were recognized at the transfiguration. The disciples recognized the risen Jesus. David said of his child who died, “I will go to him.” We will know fully, even as we are fully known. Relationships will be made perfect, not erased.

> *“For the Lord Himself will descend from heaven with a loud command, with the voice of an archangel, and with the trumpet of God, and the dead in Christ will be the first to rise. After that, we who are alive and remain will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And so we will always be with the Lord”* **(1 Thessalonians 4:16–17)**.

Also see

> “Brothers, we do not want you to be uninformed about those who sleep in death, so that you will not grieve like the rest, who are without hope. For since we believe that Jesus died and rose again, we also believe that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in Him” **(1 Thessalonians 4:13–14)**.

> “Now we see but a dim reflection as in a mirror; then we shall see face to face. Now I know in part; then I shall know fully, even as I am fully known” **(1 Corinthians 13:12)**.

> “But now that he is dead, why should I fast? Can I bring him back again? I will go to him, but he will not return to me” **(2 Samuel 12:23)**.

> “Suddenly Moses and Elijah appeared before them, talking with Jesus” **(Matthew 17:3)**.

Common self-statements

- I’ll never see my loved one again.
- We won’t recognize each other.
- Our relationship will be gone in heaven.
- Heaven will feel lonely without them.
- We’ll be strangers.
- My love for them won’t matter anymore.

Common logical errors

- **Fortune telling:** Predicting loss of relationship without Scripture saying so.
- **Mental filter:** Focusing on unknowns while overlooking promises of reunion.

- **Misreading:** Taking “no marriage in the resurrection” to mean no relationships at all.
- **Grief-driven thinking:** Letting pain shape your picture of eternity.

Challenging questions

- What does Paul say about being together with those who died in Christ?
- Were Moses and Elijah recognizable?
- Did the disciples recognize the risen Jesus?
- What did David expect about his child?
- Will I know less or more fully in heaven?
- Could relationships be made better rather than erased?
- How does this hope help me grieve today?

Truth summary

> I have good reason to hope I will know my loved ones in Christ after the resurrection. God will bring them with Jesus, and we will be together with the Lord forever. I will know fully, even as I am fully known. Our relationships will be made perfect, not erased. I can grieve with hope.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Heaven
- Grief
- Eternal Life
- Death/Dying
- Love, General

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Grief

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I won't know my loved ones after the resurrection"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I won't know my loved ones after the resurrection." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does Paul say about being together?
- ☐ Were Moses and Elijah recognized?
- ☐ Did the disciples recognize Jesus?
- ☐ What did David expect about his child?
- ☐ Will I know less or more fully?
- ☐ How does this hope help me grieve?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ We will be together with the Lord forever.
- ☐ God will bring with Jesus those who died in Him.
- ☐ I will know fully, even as I am fully known.
- ☐ Relationships will be made perfect, not erased.
- ☐ I can grieve with hope.
- ☐ Love in Christ is not lost.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Thessalonians 4:16–17**
  "For the Lord Himself will descend from heaven with a loud command, with the voice of an archangel, and with the trumpet of God, and the dead in Christ will be the first to rise. After that, we who are alive and remain will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And so we will always be with the Lord."
- [ ] **1 Thessalonians 4:13–14**
  "Brothers, we do not want you to be uninformed about those who sleep in death, so that you will not grieve like the rest, who are without hope. For since we believe that Jesus died and rose again, we also believe that God will bring with Jesus those who have fallen asleep in Him."
- [ ] **1 Corinthians 13:12**
  "Now we see but a dim reflection as in a mirror; then we shall see face to face. Now I know in part; then I shall know fully, even as I am fully known."
- [ ] **2 Samuel 12:23**
  "But now that he is dead, why should I fast? Can I bring him back again? I will go to him, but he will not return to me."
- [ ] **Matthew 17:3**
  "Suddenly Moses and Elijah appeared before them, talking with Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Reunion hope journal:** Each day, write one thing I look forward to sharing with my loved one in God's presence.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 1 Thessalonians 4:13 becomes: "**Sarah**, we do not want you to be uninformed about those who sleep in death, so that you will not grieve like the rest, who are without hope."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Grief" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18 each night this week,** and underline every word of hope.
- ☐ **Write a letter to your loved one** about what you look forward to when you see them again.
- ☐ **Read Luke 24:13–35,** and notice how the disciples recognized the risen Jesus.
- ☐ **Share a favorite memory** with someone who also loved them.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I won't know my loved ones after the resurrection": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One hope about reunion
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I won't know my loved ones after the resurrection.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for the people I love who have died in Christ. Help me reject the fear that I won't know them after the resurrection. Thank You that we will be together with the Lord forever, knowing fully as we are fully known. Help me grieve with hope. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.